men, in rich Palekys, leaning against a thick cushion of brocade, and chewing their bet-lé, for the double purpose of sweetening their breath and reddening their lips.'

In summertime, a major fruit market sells expensive 'dry fruit from Persia, Balk, Bokara, and Samarkande; such as almonds, pistachios, and walnuts, raisins, prunes, and apricots; and in winter . . . excellent fresh grapes, black and white, brought from the same countries, wrapped in cotton; pears and apples of three or four sorts, and those admirable melons which last the whole winter'. Babur, who began the Mughal Dynasty, would have loved this market. He had terribly missed grapes and melons from Bukhara and Samarkand. He had tried to grow a few on the Indian soil and even had some success with it. In *Baburnama*, his urbane memoir, he writes, 'To have grapes and melons grown in this way in Hindustan filled me with content.'[3] Clearly, he and his descendants weren't able to grow on Hindustani soil all of the grapes and melons they missed.

'To be considered a Mogol, it is enough if a foreigner have a white face and profess Mahometanism,' writes Bernier. The term 'Mogol' includes Persians, Turks, Arabs, Uzbeks and their descendants. The Persians are mostly Shia, the rest mostly Sunni. He contrasts the Mogols with others of darker complexion, the largest being the Gentiles (i.e., not of an Abrahamic faith), who have 'the languid manner of this country'. There are many ethnic and religious groupings but no 'Indian' identity. A hierarchy exists in which the Mogols heavily dominate the best imperial positions, besides a few Hindu Rajputs. The cavalry at the king's disposal, including 'those in the provinces, forms a total of more than two hundred thousand horse' and 'two, or even three hundred thousand infantry'. This includes 'servants, sutlers, tradesmen, and all those individuals belonging to bazaars' who convey 'the immense quantity of tents, kitchens, baggage, furniture, and even women, usually attendant on the army', much of it using numerous 'elephants, camels, oxen, horses, and porters'. Even a subset of this army on the move is a spectacle to behold and a very disruptive—and economically lucrative— event for the locals.

Bernier describes the opulence of the emperor and his courtiers, their grand processions, bejewelled costumes, the audience hall at Red Fort with its peacock throne and lavish furnishings of silver, gold brocade, silk and